CT BuildFest 2.0

30-HOUR CODING HACKATHON / RULES & REGULATIONS FOR PARTICIPANTS

1. General Guidelines

- The Hackathon will run from October 30–31, 2026 at CT Group of Institutions, Maqsudan.
- Each team must register officially before October 22, 2026.
- Team size: 3–6 members (as per event rules).
- All participants must carry a valid college ID card/Aadhaar Card for verification.
- Event will run according to the given schedule. Teams must report on time.
- Participants are responsible for safeguarding their belongings. The organizers are not liable for any loss or damage.

2. BYOD (Bring Your Own Device) Policy

- Participants must bring their own laptops, chargers, mobile devices, and accessories.
- Ensure your system has all required IDEs, SDKs, libraries, and frameworks pre-installed (e.g., Android Studio, Flutter, Node.js, etc., depending on your chosen tech stack).
- Carry backup storage devices (pen drive/hard disk) if needed.
- Internet will be provided, but teams should have a plan in case of connectivity issues (e.g., mobile hotspot).
- Power outlets will be shared – bring extension cords if required.

3. Registration & Check-in

- Valid college/institute ID card is mandatory at the time of entry.
- Participants must check in at the registration desk where they will receive:
- ID cards & neck slings
- Registration kits
- Refreshment coupons
- Accommodation details (if applicable) will be confirmed at check-in, must be informed 7 days before the event.
- Team leaders must submit their selected Problem Statement ID (PS ID) during physical registration on October 30, 2026. Once a PS ID is submitted at the registration desk, it will be considered final and cannot be changed under any circumstances.
- Only registered participants, mentors, and invited guests are allowed inside the competition zones.

4. Accommodation & Refreshments

- Outstation participants will be provided basic accommodation on campus on special request (separate for boys and girls).

- Refreshments as per the food coupon system.
- Participants must adhere to meal timings; late entries may not be entertained.
- Strictly no food or beverages are allowed inside the venues or computer labs or presentation halls.

5. Development Rules

- Projects must align with the given theme(s) announced at the start of the hackathon.
- Only code developed during the hackathon time window is eligible. Pre-written or plagiarized projects will lead to disqualification.
- Open-source libraries and frameworks are allowed, but must be credited.
- For security reasons, any request to unblock restricted websites or URLs on the institute's network will not be entertained. Participants who need access to such resources should use their personal mobile hotspots or other personal internet connections. This policy ensures the integrity and safety of the campus network during the hackathon.
- Teams should maintain a GitHub repository (or provided submission format) for transparency.
- At submission, teams must provide:
- Project code
- Working demo
- Short documentation (problem, solution, features, tech stack)
- PPT (Project details) PPT template will be provided on October 31, 2026

Use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) Tools

- AI tools are permitted during the hackathon for coding, development, debugging, research and other project-related activities. However, teams must clearly acknowledge and properly cite the AI tools used, specifying their purpose and contribution to the project.
- Teams will remain responsible for the originality, functionality and understanding of their submitted solutions. Failure to disclose AI assistance may affect evaluation.

Important Guidelines – CT BuildFest 2.0

1. Software Category

- Pre-developed or pre-built projects are strictly prohibited.
- Teams must develop their projects from scratch during the hackathon.
- Any team found using a pre-developed project will be immediately disqualified.

2. Hardware Category

- Pre-assembled or pre-built hardware projects are strictly prohibited.
- Participants must bring their own hardware components, tools, equipment and other essential materials.
- Hardware assembly, integration and project development must be carried out during the hackathon.
- Violation of these guidelines will result in disqualification.

6. Evaluation Criteria

- Projects will be evaluated by the jury based on the following criteria:
- Innovation – Creativity and uniqueness of the idea.
- Relevance – How well the solution addresses the theme/problem statement.
- Execution – Technical implementation and code quality.
- User Experience (UX/UI) – Simplicity, design, and usability.
- Presentation & Demo – Clarity and effectiveness of the final pitch.

Important Rule for Top 3 Positions

- Institution-Wise Ranking Restriction: To ensure fair representation and encourage wider institutional participation, only the highest-ranked team from any one college/institute shall be eligible for selection among the Top 3 winning positions (1st, 2nd and 3rd).
- If multiple teams from the same college/institute qualify for the Top 3 based on evaluation scores, only the highest-scoring team will be considered. The remaining positions will be awarded to the next highest-ranked eligible teams from other institutions.

7. Do's

- Do collaborate and divide tasks smartly within your team.
- Do ask mentors for guidance and feedback.
- Do keep regular commits and documentation of progress.
- Do test your code frequently to avoid last-minute crashes.
- Do respect fellow participants, mentors, and volunteers.
- Do take short breaks to avoid burnout.

8. Don'ts

- Don't submit copied/plagiarized code or pre-built apps.
- Don't use offensive, harmful, or illegal content in your project.
- Don't tamper with other teams' work or disrupt the event setup.
- Don't argue with judges or mentors; their decision will be final and binding.
- Don't forget submission deadlines – late entries won't be considered.

9. Code of Conduct

- Maintain professionalism and team spirit throughout the event.
- Any kind of harassment, abusive language, or misconduct will lead to immediate disqualification.
- Alcohol, drugs, and smoking are strictly prohibited at the venue.

10. Safety & Security Protocols

- Security checks will be conducted at entry and exit points.
- Security guards per floor will be on duty in all shifts.
- Emergency medical support will be on standby; report any incident immediately to organizers.
- No participant is allowed to leave the campus premises without prior permission.
- Any damage to college property will be penalized and may lead to disqualification.

11. Grounds for Disqualification

- Use of pre-built projects or plagiarized code.
- Violation of campus discipline and safety rules.
- Misbehavior with mentors, judges, or fellow participants.
- Tampering with another team's work or college equipment.
- Failure to follow BYOD and security guidelines.
- Leaving campus without informing organizers.

By participating, you agree to abide by these rules and regulations.

Get ready to innovate, build, and showcase your ideas at CT BuildFest 2.0!